

KALE REALTY

YOUR BUYERS THINK THIS MARKET FLIPPED. IT DIDN'T.

Inventory is still below what NAR calls a balanced market.

“

**4.6 MONTHS OF
SUPPLY.
UNCHANGED FROM
A YEAR AGO.**

A balanced market needs five to six.

BUYERS ARE NEGOTIATING LIKE SELLERS LOST THEIR LEVERAGE. THE NUMBER SAYS THEY HAVEN'T.

NAR's July 2026 existing-home sales report, published August 11, 2026, put the median existing-home price at \$434,100, up 2.0 percent from a year earlier, with 4.6 months of supply, the exact same figure as one year before. NAR chief economist Lawrence Yun has said a genuinely balanced market runs five to six months of supply. A buyer holding out for October, expecting more room to negotiate, is negotiating against a market that never actually loosened.

SAY THIS THE NEXT TIME A BUYER SAYS "WE'LL WAIT":

- 1 Lead with the number, not the vibe.**
"Inventory is sitting at 4.6 months right now, the same as it was a year ago. That's not a market opening up."
- 2 Name the floor.**
"A balanced market runs five to six months of supply. We're still below that."
- 3 Reframe the wait.**
"Prices are still up 2 percent from last year. Waiting hasn't been the discount play."

THE TAKEAWAY

**THE MARKET
DIDN'T LOOSEN.
YOUR BUYER'S
ASSUMPTION DID.**

Bring the number to the next consultation, not just the listings.